

Doping Stability Report -- Cr in LiCoO₂ at 320 C

Generated: 2026-05-31 02:24 Host: LiCoO₂ Dopant: Cr

Executive Summary

Cr preferentially occupies the Co layer. The formation energy difference between the two layers is +9.010 eV, strongly favouring the Co site. MD confirms this preference: on the Co site the dopant MSD plateau slope is -0.00339 Å²/ps (stable), compared to 0.01433 Å²/ps on the Li site. The Co-site result is isovalent (no charge mismatch), so the formation energy is fully reliable. The Li-site E_f is approximate due to a charge surplus of +2 that cannot be modelled in CHGNet.

Site	E _f (eV)	Charge	Compensation	MSD pass	Coord pass	Verdict
Co	-3.101	+0	No	PASS	FAIL	STRUCTURAL COLLAPSE
Li	+5.909	+2	Yes	FAIL	PASS	MIGRATION / UNFAVORABLE

Cr at the Co layer -- STRUCTURAL COLLAPSE

Charge situation

Cr replaces Co with no change in oxidation state (isovalent substitution, charge mismatch = 0). No charge compensation is needed. The formation energy is fully reliable.

Formation Energy (thermodynamic stability)

Formation energy E _f	-3.1013 eV	PASS	< 1.0 eV to pass
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E_f = -3.101 eV. This value is exceptionally large and negative, indicating that Cr incorporation is strongly thermodynamically driven at the Co site.

Molecular Dynamics Stability (320 C, 25 ps)

MSD slope (late-time)	-0.00339 Å²/ps	PASS	< 0.005 to pass (plateau = stable)
Final MSD	0.105 Å²	----	
Max displacement	1.055 Å	----	
Coordination (min/mean/max)	6 / 6.1 / 8	FAIL	relaxed = 6, tolerance +/-1
Mean bond length (MD vs relaxed)	1.980 Å (relaxed: 1.9)	----	
Lattice volume change	+0.00 %	PASS	< +/-5% to pass

Late-time MSD slope = -0.00339 Å²/ps. The negative slope is a flat plateau -- essentially no migration detected. Final MSD = 0.105 Å²; maximum displacement from starting position = 1.06 Å.

Coordination fluctuated between 6 and 8 (mean 6.1), deviating by more than +/-1 from the relaxed value (6). This may indicate structural distortion, or that the bond-length cutoff is too close to the actual bond length -- check the coordination_cutoff_A setting. Mean nearest-neighbour distance during MD = 1.980 Å.

Volume change = +0.00%. The host lattice is mechanically intact.

VERDICT: STRUCTURAL COLLAPSE

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The coordination criterion failed while MSD and volume both pass, suggesting a possible cutoff artifact rather than a true structural collapse. The Cr atom barely moves (MSD = 0.105 Å²) but the coordination count fluctuates because the bond length at the Co site is close to the analysis cutoff. Consider increasing coordination_cutoff_A and re-running analysis.

Cr at the Li layer -- MIGRATION / UNFAVORABLE

Charge situation

Cr replaces Li with a charge surplus of +2. CHGNet cannot model this compensation (would require Co oxidation or electron addition). The formation energy below is approximate.

Formation Energy (thermodynamic stability)

Formation energy E _f	+5.9091 eV	FAIL	< 1.0 eV to pass
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E_f = +5.909 eV (approximate -- charge surplus not modelled in CHGNet). This value is large and positive, indicating that Cr incorporation is thermodynamically unfavorable under equilibrium conditions at the Li site.

Molecular Dynamics Stability (320 C, 25 ps)

MSD slope (late-time)	0.01433 Å²/ps	FAIL	< 0.005 to pass (plateau = stable)
Final MSD	5.484 Å²	----	
Max displacement	2.861 Å	----	
Coordination (min/mean/max)	6 / 6.1 / 7	PASS	relaxed = 6, tolerance +/-1
Mean bond length (MD vs relaxed)	2.022 Å (relaxed: 2.0)	----	
Lattice volume change	+0.00 %	PASS	< +/-5% to pass

Late-time MSD slope = 0.01433 Å²/ps. The slope exceeds the plateau threshold, suggesting mild drift or site-hopping. Final MSD = 5.484 Å²; maximum displacement from starting position = 2.86 Å.

Coordination fluctuated between 6 and 7 (mean 6.1), within the +/-1 tolerance of the relaxed value (6). This is consistent with normal thermal vibration. Mean nearest-neighbour distance during MD = 2.022 Å.

Volume change = +0.00%. The host lattice is mechanically intact.

VERDICT: MIGRATION / UNFAVORABLE

The formation energy is favorable but Cr migrates away from the Li site during MD. The relaxed structure is not the true resting site. Inspect the MSD and trajectory to identify where the dopant ends up.

Site Preference Comparison

The Co site is preferred by 9.010 eV over the Li site. Formation energy: -3.101 eV (Co) vs +5.909 eV (Li).

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Caveats and Limitations

? CHGNet is charge-neutral.

The potential does not model oxidation states, polaron formation, or electron/hole localisation. Formation energies for aliovalent dopants (charge mismatch $\neq 0$) are approximate even when structural compensation defects are included.

? No Freysoldt/Kumagai correction.

Electrostatic finite-size corrections for charged defects require the host dielectric tensor and the DFT electrostatic potential, neither of which is available from a neural-network potential. For publication-quality E_f of charged defects, follow up with DFT using doped or pymatgen-analysis-defects.

? Metal-rich reference state.

Chemical potentials are computed from elemental ground-state structures. Synthesis under oxide-rich or other conditions shifts all E_f values by additive constants; the relative ordering of sites is unaffected.

? MD timescales are short (25 ps default).

This is sufficient to assess local site stability and rapid migration, but cannot resolve slow diffusion mechanisms. A non-plateauing MSD confirms instability; a plateau does not guarantee stability on longer timescales.

? Energy rankings are more trustworthy than absolute values.

CHGNet is a universal MLIP trained on r2SCAN DFT. Formation-energy errors for transition-metal oxides are typically 50-150 meV/atom. Use relative orderings (which site is preferred?) as the primary result.